
Phyllanthus amarus


Justicia adhatoda


Andrographis paniculata


Curcuma longa

Figure 10.21: Medicinal Plants

places in plains. *Phyllanthus maderspatensis* is also commonly sold in the medicinal plant markets collected from non-forest are as keezhanelli.

Active principle: Phyllanthin is the major chemical component.

Medicinal importance

Phyllanthus is a well-known hepato-protective plant generally used in Tamil Nadu for the treatment of Jaundice. Research carried out by Dr. S P Thyagarajan and his team from University of Madras has scientifically proved that the extract of *P. amarus* is effective against hepatitis B virus.

Adathodai

Botanical name : *Justicia adhatoda*

Family: Acanthaceae

Origin and Area of cultivation: It is native to India and Srilanka. This species is not known in wild in Tamil Nadu but widely cultivated as a live fence and around temples.

Active principle: Vascin

Medicinal importance:

Adhatoda possess **broncho dilating** property. The decoction is used in treating many bronchial disorders such as cough,cold and asthma. It is also used in treating fevers. The extract forms an ingredient of cough syrups.

Nilavembu

Botanical name : *Andrographis paniculata*

Family : Acanthaceae

Andrographis paniculata, known as the **King of Bitters** is traditionally used in Indian systems of medicines.

Active principle: Andrographolides.

Medicinal importance:

Andrographis is a **potent hepatoprotective** and is widely used to treat liver disorders.

Table 4: Other common Medicinal plants

S. No	Common Name	Tamil Name	Botanical Name	Family	Plant part used	Medicinal Uses
1	Holy basil	துளசி	*Ocimum sanctum*	Lamiaceae	Leaves and Roots	The leaves are stimulant, antiseptic, anti-hypertensive and anti-bacterial and expectorant used in bronchitis. Decoction of roots is given as a diaphoretic in malarial fevel.
2	Indian gooseberry	நெல்லி	*Phyllanthus emblica*	Phyllanthaceae	Fruit	It is a potent rejuvenator and immune modulator. It has a anti-ageing properties. It helps to promote longevity, enhance digestion, treat constipation and reduce fever and cough.
3	Indian Acalypha	குப்பைமேனி	*Acalypha indica*	Euphorbiaceae	Leaves	Used to cure skin diseases caused by ringworms. Powdered leaves are used to cure bedsores and infected wounds.
4	Vilvam	வில்வம்	*Aegle marmelos*	Rutaceae	Fruit	The unripe fruit is used to treat problems of stomach indigestion. It kills intestinal parasites.
5	Veldt grape	பிரண்டை	*Cissus quadrangularis*	Vitaceae	Stem and root	Paste obtained from the powdered stem and root of this plant is used in bone fractures. Whole plant is useful to treat asthma and stomach troubles.

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